SS-B-668B
May 20, 1974
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. SS-B-668A
September 6, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRICK, FACING, CLAY, OR SHALE

The specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers facing brick, including solid clay masonry units, for use in exposed interior or exterior masonry walls.

1.2 Classification. Facing brick shall be of the following grades and types as specified (see 6.2):

1.2.1 Grades.

SW - Severe weathering.
MW - Moderate weathering.

1.2.2 Types.

FBS - Standard.
FBX - Mechanical (see 6.1.4).
FBA - Architectural.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized and Containerized Unit Loads 40 inch X 48 inch Pallets, Skids, Runners, or Pallet Type Base.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards:

C-67 - Brick, Sampling and Testing.
C-216 - Specification for Facing Brick (Solid Masonry Units Made from Clay or Shale).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

American National Standards Institute:

A62.3 - Clay and Concrete Modular Masonry Units, Sizes of.

(Application for copies should be addressed to American National Standards Institute, Inc., 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza., Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Grade and type. Each grade and type of facing brick shall meet the requirements of ASTM C-216.

3.2 Size. The size of the brick shall be as specified (see 6.2 and 6.3).

3.3 Color and texture. Color and texture meet the requirements of ASTM C-216 (see 6.2).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling. The size of the lot and samples for visual examination, dimensional characteristics and test shall be in accordance with ASTM C-67.

4.3 Test. Brick shall be tested in accordance with ASTM C-67.

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery. The packing and marking of the brick shall be inspected to determine conformance with the applicable requirements of Section 5.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY.

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. The brick shall be packed in fiberboard boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant or PPP-B-640, class 2, grade A. Dividers shall be used to prevent damage, and cushioning shall be used to fill all voids to insure a compact fit. The boxes shall be waterproof sealed in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification. The triple wall fiberboard boxes shall not exceed approximately 200 pounds and fiberboard boxes shall not exceed the weight limitation of the specification. Flat steel strapping shall be type I, class B.

5.1.2 Level B. The brick shall be packed in fiberboard boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic or PPP-B-640, class 1, grade B. Dividers shall be used to prevent damage, and cushioning shall be used to fill all voids to insure a compact fit.

5.1.3 Level C. Level C packing of the subject commodity shall be substantial commercial containers of the type and size commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers at the lowest rate to the point of delivery.

5.1.4 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), the packed brick shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147 for type I load.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.

6.1.1 Grade SW. Brick intended for use where a high and uniform degree of resistance to frost action and disintegration by weathering is desired and the exposure is such that the brick may be frozen when permeated with water.

6.1.2 Grade MW. Brick intended for use where a moderate and somewhat non-uniform degree of resistance to frost action is permissible or where they are unlikely to be permeated with water when exposed to temperature below freezing.

6.1.3 Type FBS. Brick for general use in exposed exterior and interior masonry walls and partitions where wider color ranges and greater variations in size are permitted than are specified for type FBX.

6.1.4 Type FBX. Brick for general use in exposed exterior and interior masonry walls and partitions where a high degree of mechanical perfection, narrow color range, and minimum permissible variation in size are required.

6.1.5 Type FBA. Brick manufactured and selected to produce characteristics architectural effects resulting from nonuniformity in size, color, and texture of the individual units.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Grade and type of brick (1.2.1, 1.2.2 and 6.3).
(c) Size of brick (3.2 and 6.3).
(d) Color and texture of brick (see 3.3).
(e) Level of packing required (see 5.1).
(f) If palletizing is required (see 5.1.4).
(g) Marking required (see 5.2).

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6.3 Sizes. For a list of modular sizes, see the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) A62.3 Clay and Concrete Modular Masonry Units, Sizes of. Not all of the sizes listed in this standard are produced in some parts of the United States, and purchasers should ascertain the size or size available (see 2.2).

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY

COMMERCE-NBS
DOT-FIS
GSA-POD
HEW-FEC
INTERIOR-BPA
USDA-AFS

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